

VISA MASTER

A privacy-first AI workspace for travelers who prepare their own visa applications.

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The Problem

Travelers currently choose between an expensive, privacy-sensitive agency and a fragmented, time-consuming DIY process.

Two Bad Options

USE AN AGENCY

\$500

Quoted for a single family application

Administrative burden goes away, but so does control: passport, financial, and employment documents are handed to a third party.

DO IT YOURSELF

Many hours

Spread across several days, in our own family's case

Fragmented rules, unfamiliar forms, supporting evidence to assemble, files scattered across devices, and no structure for a group.

Today the applicant chooses between cost and hours — and neither path leaves them in control of their own documents.

Origin & Insight

The requirements were all public. What did not exist was a **workflow** an applicant could execute — one that kept the sensitive documents where they already were.

\$500

The agency quote that started the project, for one family application.

Spain

A real Spanish Schengen family application is the first end-to-end validation of the product.

Customer Segments

SEGMENT	PAIN POINT	INITIAL VALUE PROPOSITION
Independent individuals	Confusing requirements and unfamiliar forms	A personalized, sourced checklist and a guided local workspace
Families and groups	Duplicated information, scattered files, coordination overhead	Shared progress structure with separate private applicant data
Older or less technical travelers	Long reports and government portals are difficult to execute	Grandma-friendly steps, templates, and clear completion states
Travel agencies and advisors	Manual intake, repetitive document checks, fragmented client communication	A future white-label workflow and review layer

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The Product

From fragmented information to a private, executable application workspace.

What Visa Master Is

Visa Master turns verified visa requirements into a guided workspace on the applicant's own machine — one they can actually execute.

Sourced

Requirements are gathered from official consulate and visa-center sites, then shown as a short checklist — each item carrying its source link and the date it was last checked.

Local

Passport, financial, employment, and family answers are completed and stored in a local workspace, not sent to a general-purpose AI system.

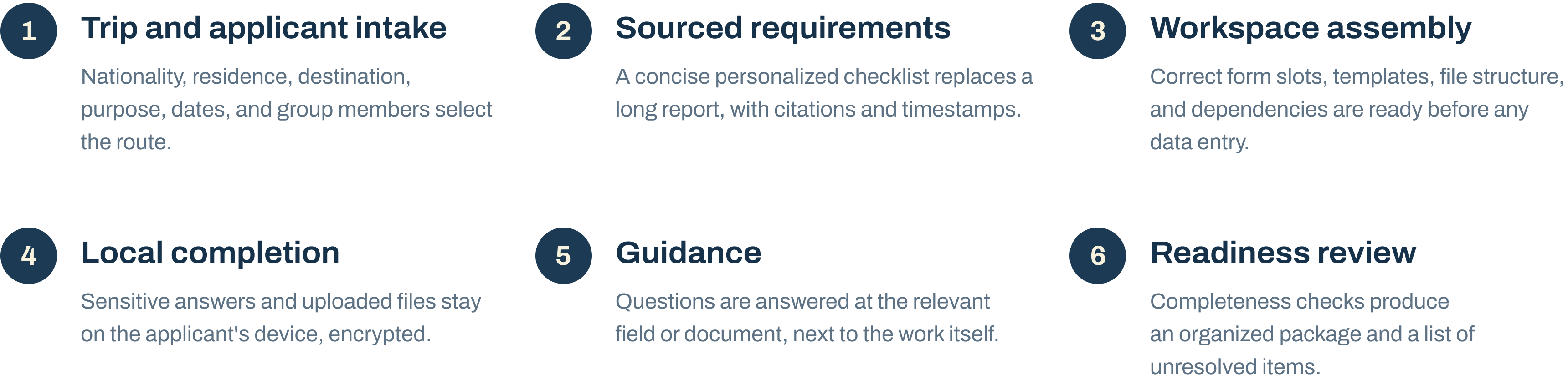
Executable

Official forms arrive pre-downloaded, reference templates fill the gaps, progress is tracked per applicant, and the result exports as an organized package.

First customer: Chinese ordinary-passport holders preparing Schengen and U.S. B1/B2 short-stay visas independently. \$29 per application workspace.

Core Workflow

Six steps from a trip description to a submission-ready package. Personal data is only requested once the structure around it exists.



Privacy & Trust Design

Local-first handling is built into the workflow as product behavior, not stated as a policy.

Local by default	Personal answers and uploaded documents remain in the user-controlled local workspace.
Data minimization	Only the non-sensitive context needed for research or guidance reaches an external AI service.
Source transparency	Every requirement links to an official source and shows when it was last checked.
Material labeling	Official forms, guidance, product interpretation, and AI templates are visually distinct.
User control	Users can inspect, export, or delete the workspace at any time.

No approval is promised, and none is implied.

Visa decisions stay with governments. Ambiguous or high-risk guidance is escalated to manual review rather than presented with false certainty — the product competes on accuracy and control, not on outcome claims.

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The Market

A large outbound-travel market, entered through a narrow and measurable visa-preparation segment.

Market Opportunity

The serviceable market is defined by visa-preparation events, not by the tourism economy as a whole.

1.9M Chinese Schengen short-stay applications 2025 · European Commission	645,977 U.S. B1/B2 visas issued to mainland Chinese nationals FY2024 · U.S. Dept. of State	167.92M Mainland Chinese outbound visits 2025 · NBS China	55.21M Of those, beyond Hong Kong, Macao, and Taiwan Derived from 2025 NBS data
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TAM \$1.60B

Travel lifecycle · 55.21M visits × \$29

SAM \$73.8M

Visa preparation · 2.55M service events × \$29

SOM \$870K

24-month target · 30,000 paid workspaces

Competitive Landscape

ALTERNATIVE	STRENGTH	THE GAP WE TARGET
Traditional travel agencies	High-touch service and local familiarity	Higher cost; sensitive documents shared with third parties; limited user control
General-purpose AI chatbots	Fast research and question answering	Long text-heavy output; no persistence, no execution, no privacy boundary
Harnessed AI agents	Can manipulate local files and automate tasks	Broad permissions and unclear data boundaries create trust concerns
Atlys and iVisa	Guided forms, document review, broad destination coverage	Cloud-centric service model; Visa Master differentiates on DIY workflows and local-first handling

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Business Model

Start with a low-friction paid application workspace; expand into partner and travel-lifecycle revenue.

Pricing & Revenue Streams

\$29

Introductory price per application workspace, rising to \$39–69 by route complexity.

6 MONTHS

\$29K

1,000 workspaces · 70% margin

12 MONTHS

\$392K

8,000 workspaces · 76% margin

24 MONTHS

\$1.77M

30,000 workspaces · 80% margin

Individual application workspace

MVP launch

Family / group pack

After core workflow validation

Expert review add-on

Pilot with partner agencies

B2B workflow licensing

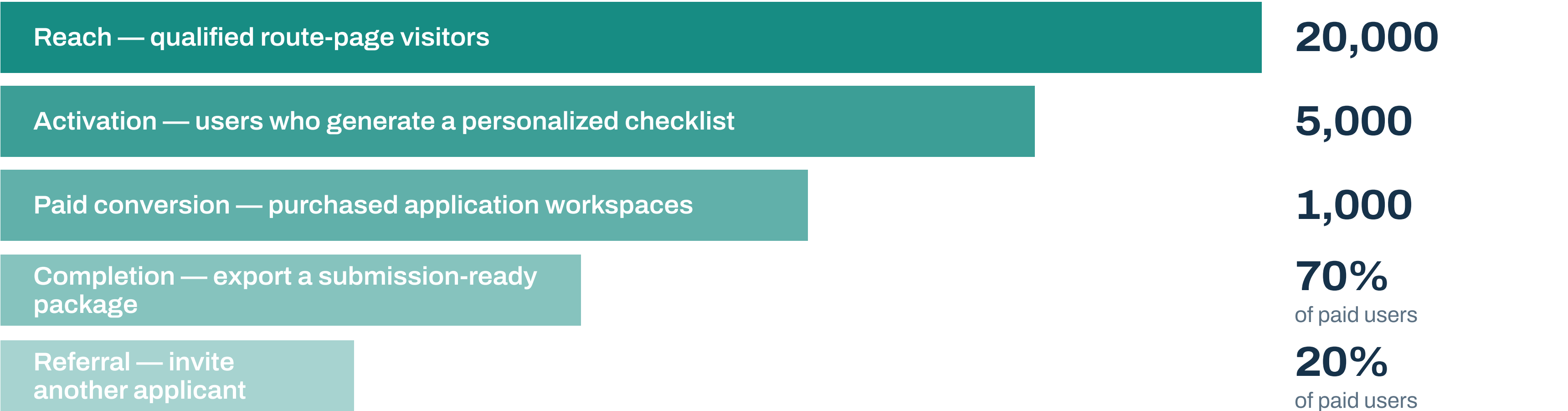
After repeatable B2C workflow

Travel-platform monetization

Long-term · excluded from the forecast

Go-to-Market

Six-month funnel targets. Every channel points at an executable workspace rather than at another report.



Founder-led pilot

Family networks, JHU and UMBC communities, direct referrals.

Agency partnerships

A lower-cost preparation layer that feeds qualified customers to professional review.

Chinese social platforms

Route-specific, source-backed content and paid KOL work on WeChat, RedNote, Douyin.

Referral loops

Family and group applications expose the product to additional applicants.

Financial Plan

Illustrative base case. All projections are management assumptions, and future travel-platform revenue is excluded throughout.

PERIOD	PAID WORKSPACES	ARPU	REVENUE	GROSS PROFIT	PROFIT
6 months	1,000	\$29	\$29,000	\$20,300	\$300
12 months	8,000	\$49	\$392,000	\$297,920	\$247,920
24 months	30,000	\$59	\$1,770,000	\$1,416,000	\$1,216,000

Gross margin moves from 70% to 80% as route research is amortized across more applicants. The current competition application lists Visa Master as self-funded and not seeking funding, so the first six months are treated as a founder-funded validation period.

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Execution

Route depth before geographic breadth, and evidence before every expansion.

Expansion Path

Visa preparation creates verified applicant, trip, and group context. With the traveler's permission, that context carries into the rest of the journey — but only after the wedge shows paid demand.

PHASE 1 · NOW

Visa preparation

Personalized Schengen and U.S. B1/B2 requirements, local document completion, application-readiness workspaces.

Validate source accuracy, time saved, package completion, and paid conversion.

PHASE 2

Pre-trip readiness

Itinerary coordination, booking and insurance reminders, and group preparation inside the existing trip workspace.

Do Phase 1 customers keep using Visa Master before departure?

PHASE 3

In-trip coordination

The prepared itinerary becomes a shared, adaptable workspace for schedule changes and destination guidance.

Trip-day usage and participation across group members.

PHASE 4

Post-trip creation

Shared memories organized into optional AI-assisted albums, stories, and video drafts.

Creation completion, sharing, referrals, and organic acquisition.

Risks & Controls

Maintaining trustworthy, current, jurisdiction-specific workflows is the primary challenge.

RISK	WHY IT MATTERS	MITIGATION
Requirements change by jurisdiction	Outdated or generalized instructions cause delays and destroy trust	Version every source with last-checked dates; separate shared from consulate-specific rules
Guidance read as legal advice	Visa decisions rest with governments; misrepresentation has serious consequences	Explicit disclaimers, source-level evidence, confidence flags, no approval guarantees
Sensitive data leakage	The product handles passport, financial, employment, and family data	Local-first storage, encryption, data minimization, deletion controls, security review
Scope expansion reduces quality	Too many destinations too early creates shallow, unreliable workflows	Validate Spain Schengen and U.S. B1/B2 first; require route-specific acceptance tests
Established platforms copy features	Atlys and iVisa already offer guided, broad online visa services	Differentiate on China-specific experience, local-first privacy, executable workspaces, partner distribution
Low willingness to pay	Users may prefer free chatbots despite poorer workflow quality	Test \$29 early; measure time saved, completion, referral, and conversion before scaling spend

Team

A two-founder team with prior startup collaboration and complementary products.

Deer Ma

CEO · PRODUCT

Recent Johns Hopkins University graduate; previously worked in A&R at a leading Chinese record label. Brings product design and an international-user perspective.

Owns customer discovery, product design, travel-agency partnerships, and go-to-market.

Dayuan Tan

CTO · ENGINEERING

Computer Science Ph.D. candidate at UMBC with industry experience at Ciena; expertise in AI, machine learning, distributed systems, and full-stack development.

Owns local-first architecture, security, the data pipeline, quality systems, and technical execution.

The two previously co-founded IMMURTAL, a music-technology venture that received the Audience Choice Award at the Johns Hopkins FastForward U Spark Showcase in Spring 2023.

Execution Milestones

Each stage has an exit criterion. Nothing scales until the stage before it produces evidence.

2 months	Build the local workspace foundation; implement official-source capture; complete Spain Schengen and U.S. B1/B2 workflow maps.	Exit: internal end-to-end application package; security and source-labeling review.
3 months	Run 50–100 assisted beta cases; test with individuals and families; establish one travel-agency partner.	Exit: measured time savings, error categories, and willingness-to-pay evidence.
4–6 months	Launch the \$29 paid MVP; add group coordination and review exports; reach 1,000 paid workspaces.	Exit: 70% completion rate, 20% referral rate, and route-level unit economics.
12 months	Expand visa routes and B2B pilots; test pre-trip coordination features.	Exit: repeatable acquisition channels and positive operating contribution.



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